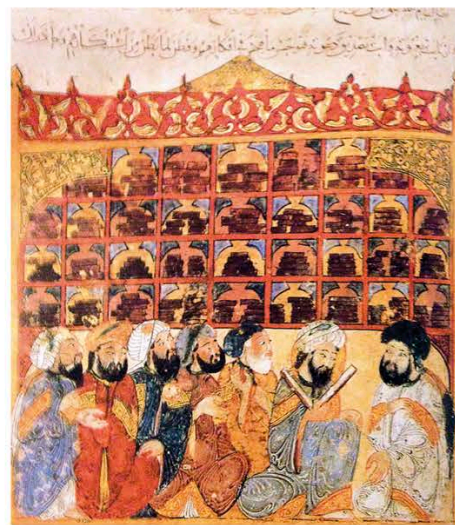


ISLAMIC ART AND SCIENCE

The rule of the Abbasid Dynasty (750–1258) is considered a golden age of Islam. Science, culture, and art flourished as great thinkers from across the empire flocked to the new capital Baghdad, which also became a center for trade. Classical Greek texts were translated into Arabic, leading to important advances in the fields of math, astronomy, the arts, philosophy, and medicine. The thirst for knowledge in Baghdad was helped by the

new practice of book binding. The Abbasids also learned how to make paper from the Chinese and could now produce it on a large scale, making books more widely available. The famous collection of Arabic folk tales, *One Thousand and One Nights*, was compiled during the golden age of Islam.



▲ HOUSE OF WISDOM

Baghdad was a center of learning and its libraries were stocked with books on medicine, mathematics, astronomy, philosophy, and poetry. Abbasid Caliph Haroun al-Rashid founded the House of Wisdom, also known as the Grand Library of Baghdad, which flourished under his son, al-Ma'mun, in the early 9th century.

FACT

The Fatimid Caliphate, rulers of Egypt, built the Al-Azhar mosque for their new capital city of Cairo in 972. This place of learning became the world's second oldest university.

▼ DECORATIVE ART

In Islamic architecture, geometric patterns rather than human or animal figures were commonly used as decoration. These patterns included repeated circles, squares, stars, and multi-sided polygons. The Jameh mosque in the city of Yazd in Iran, built in the 14th century, is decorated with exquisite geometric designs.

